

1. In defense of not understanding your codebase

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Sat, 11 Jul 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/in-defense-of-not-understanding-your-codebase/>

As a software engineer, how well do you have to understand your own codebase? My guess is that people who work on small codebases with low-turnover teams (say, Redis or games like The Witness) would say ?obviously you have to understand it completely, otherwise you can?t do good work?. I?d also guess that people who work on large codebases with high-turnover teams (say, the Google web search backend or GitHub) would say ?obviously you can?t understand it completely, you just have to do the best you can in your local area?. These are two largely different ways of programming with different methods, practices and cultures 1 . However, the first group is over-represented in online discussion about software engineering 2 . I want to defend the second group against the first. In many software engineering environments, there?s nothing wrong with being in a state of partial understanding. In fact, in large systems a partial understanding is the best you can do. Against ?programming as theory building? The best articulation of the ?you have to understand your codebase? side is Peter Naur?s famous paper Programming as Theory Building . I like this paper, but I think it goes too far in tha...

2. sqlite-utils 4.1

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-11T23:50:20+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/11/sqlite-utils/#atom-everything>

Release: sqlite-utils 4.1 The first dot-release since 4.0 a few days ago , introducing a number of minor new features. sqlite-utils insert and sqlite-utils upsert now accept a --code option for providing a block of Python code (or a path to a .py file) that defines a rows() function or rows iterable of rows to insert, as an alternative to importing from a file. (#684) sqlite-utils already had features that allow you to pass blocks of Python code as CLI arguments, for example this one for the sqlite-utils convert command: sqlite - utils convert content . db articles headline ' def convert (value): return value . upper ()' Allowing blocks of code to generate new rows directly was an obvious extension of that pattern: sqlite - utils insert data . db creatures - - code ' def rows (): yield { "id" : 1 , "name" : "Cleo" } yield { "id" : 2 , "name" : "Suna" } ' - - pk id sqlite-utils insert and sqlite-utils upsert now accept --type column-name type to override the type automatically chosen when the table is created . This is useful for CSV or TSV columns such as ZIP codes that look like integers but should be stored as TEXT to preserve leading zeros. (#131) A long-standing feature...

3. sqlite-utils 4.0

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-07T15:42:43+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/7/sqlite-utils/#atom-everything>

Release: sqlite-utils 4.0 See sqlite-utils 4.0, now with database schema migrations for details. Tags: sqlite-utils

4. sqlite-utils 4.0rc4

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-07T05:36:15+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/7/sqlite-utils-2/#atom-everything>

Release: sqlite-utils 4.0rc4 The last RC before the 4.0 stable release. Mainly implements feedback from a detailed review by Claude Fable 5. Tags: sqlite-utils , claude-mythos-fable

5. Can Someone Explain to Me How to Get ?ChatGPT Classic??

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-11T22:38:39Z

Link: <https://help.openai.com/en/articles/20001276-moving-to-the-new-chatgpt-desktop-app>

One more link from OpenAI's Help Center, this one explaining how to upgrade from the old Mac app to the new ?super? app version: Follow the prompt in the app to download the new ChatGPT desktop app. Then sign in with the same ChatGPT account. The new app may install alongside your

current app. If both remain installed, you will see: ChatGPT : The new app with Chat, Work, and Codex. ChatGPT Classic : The previous ChatGPT desktop app. You can continue using it; no migration is required at launch. It continues to receive model updates, bug fixes, security patches, and support for its existing Enterprise capabilities. New agent features may be available only in the new app. None of this has been my experience. I had the existing old ChatGPT app installed on three different Macs. On all three of them, the built-in "Check for Updates" command only installs the latest version of the classic app. This is good, I suppose. But if you're not aware from following the news that OpenAI released an altogether new "super" app for MacOS and Windows, you'd never know it from the Check for Updates command built into the classic Mac app. So I don't see "the prompt in the app to download the new ChatG...

6. OpenAI Help Center Describes What Is Wrong With the New ChatGPT

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-11T22:24:20Z

Link: <https://help.openai.com/en/articles/20001275-chatgpt-work-and-codex>

OpenAI Help Center, "Where Work and Codex are available": Work is available on ChatGPT web and mobile for eligible paid plans. Work is also available in the ChatGPT desktop app when included for your plan and workspace. Work on web and mobile runs in the cloud. Work in the desktop app can also use local files and desktop apps with your permission. At launch, cloud Work conversations do not appear in desktop Work; desktop Work threads and local files remain on that computer. Codex is available as a mode in the ChatGPT desktop app. It can work with local folders, repositories, terminals, and developer tools. Codex is not a selectable mode on web or mobile. You can access supported desktop Codex tasks from the Remote tab in the ChatGPT mobile app, but those tasks do not become web or mobile chat history. These three paragraphs, from OpenAI's own Help Center, sound more like a critic's scathing review of what's wrong with the new ChatGPT "super" app than a guide to how to use it. "

7. Benedict Evans on the New "Super App" ChatGPT

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-11T22:16:21Z

Link: https://www.threads.com/@benedictdevans/post/Dano_uvDr8F

Benedict Evans with a succinct review on Threads: Wow, what a total mess. What is the difference between a project, a task and a chat? Why did chats get a crappy floating window but tasks and projects don't? Why does choosing "plugins" get me "templates"? Am I not allowed to finish "setup" if I don't use Slack or Google Drive? I forget how I made the Setup dickbar disappear despite my not using Slack or Google Drive. It was confusing. It is sometimes observed that in companies dominated by internal politics, their shipped product (and public keynotes) reflect the company's org chart. That's never been truer than with the new ChatGPT app. OpenAI's internal org chart is a complete disorganized mess . This new app perfectly reflects that. The old ChatGPT app was focused. That's the app that still ships for mobile (which includes iPad, which tells you whether OpenAI thinks iPad is a real computer or a big iPhone), and is, for some Mac users, left installed on their systems as "ChatGPT Classic". The new app is an incredibly confusing sloppy mess. At a glance it looks like a polished app. But the UI is just slop . It has the veneer of a polished app without actually being organized or S...

8. Progress on Gilbreath's conjecture

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sat, 11 Jul 2026 21:30:11 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/07/11/progress-on-gilbreaths-conjecture/>

Years ago I wrote about Gilbreath's conjecture. It's a simple conjecture; you could explain it to anyone who understands what prime numbers are. See the linked post for a description of the problem. Gilbreath's conjecture is simple, but it's also kinda weird. As I wrote before, Paul Erd's speculated that Gilbreath's conjecture is true but [?] The post Progress on Gilbreath's conjecture first appeared on John D. Cook .

9. Prefer STRICT tables in SQLite

Source: Evan Hahn (dot com) | Published: Sat, 11 Jul 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://evanhahn.com/prefer-strict-tables-in-sqlite/>

In short: I prefer strict tables in SQLite because they avoid some datatype problems, such as putting text in number columns. SQLite has a feature that I think is underrated: strict tables. Strict tables help enforce rigid typing, preventing mistakes like putting text into integer columns. I like them, and wrote this post to promote their use! To make a strict table, add STRICT to the end of its definition. Like this: `-CREATE TABLE people (name TEXT); +CREATE TABLE people (name TEXT) STRICT;` That's it! But what does it do? Advantages of strict tables Broadly, strict tables help enforce rigid types, like other SQL engines do. Prevents type mismatches on insert/update Most significantly, strict tables keep you from inserting the wrong type into a column. For example, SQLite normally lets you put text into an INTEGER column, but not with strict tables. -- Non-strict tables let you put anything anywhere. `CREATE TABLE people_nonstrict (age INTEGER); INSERT INTO people_nonstrict (age) VALUES ( 'garbage' );` -- => works fine -- Strict tables don't allow that, which I prefer. `CREATE TABLE people_strict (age INTEGER) STRICT ; INSERT INTO people_strict (age) VALUES ( 'garbage' );` -- => erro...

10. Reading List 07/11/26

Source: Construction Physics | Published: Sat, 11 Jul 2026 12:01:33 GMT

Link: <https://www.construction-physics.com/p/reading-list-071126>

Adults living with their parents, Samsung's profits, Native American data centers, Puerto Rico's electricity grid, and more.

11. This Week in Package Management: 11 July 2026

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-07-11T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/07/11/this-week-in-package-management.html>

Week eight of the roundup, built from the package manager OPML feed collection and whatever I've posted or boosted on Mastodon. Releases npm 12.0.0 is out. allow-git and allow-remote now default to none, so installing git dependencies or user-supplied tarball URLs needs explicit opt-in. npm shrinkwrap is removed and npm-shrinkwrap.json is no longer honoured at the project root or inside dependency tarballs. Unknown .npmrc keys, unknown CLI flags and abbreviated flags now error instead of warn, root preinstall runs before dependencies are installed, and npm adduser, star and unstar are gone. pnpm 11.10 adds an _auth setting that takes registry credentials as a single URL-keyed structure, so CI can pass them via pnpm_config__auth without the shell-quoting problems that broke the per-registry env vars. It also adds pnpm prefix and pnpm issues, and pnpm self-update can now install v12, the Rust port. 11.11 followed with a pnpm access command for managing registry visibility, MFA requirements and team access, and lets allowBuilds entries for git-hosted packages match by repository URL without pinning a commit hash. uv 0.11.28 hardens ZIP handling against parser differentials via an...

12. AI 2040 and the Cult of Intelligence

Source: the singularity is nearer | Published: 2026-07-11T00:00:00-07:00

Link: <https://geohot.github.io/blog/jekyll/update/2026/07/11/ai-2040.html>

I used to be one of these people. I read Yudkowsky and was like, OMG recursive self improvement hard takeoff AI is coming. Then I joined the real world and actually tried to do things. At comma, we ship a hardware product of similar complexity to a cell phone, and it's really hard. Reality has lots of finicky details. I would like to see the authors of this document try to change a bike tire. Even with a superintelligent ChatGPT, I suspect they would struggle. In The Metamorphosis of Prime Intellect, the hard takeoff works because AI discovers the correlation effect, some quantum trick to manipulate matter. In reality, there is no correlation effect. No matter how high quality your tokens are, they cannot turn lead into gold. Confronting why these people are wrong requires confronting deep beliefs I hold about myself. Intelligence is not the end all be all, it's just the current bottleneck for a few things. You cannot take over the world with tokens. Software didn't eat the world, it largely removed one layer of friction then reintroduced it for the benefit of a few tech companies. That said, machines, or some hybrid, are long term probably the successor species to humanity. Spac...

13. A dock that finally wakes up reliably

Source: Fabien Sanglard | Published: 11 Jul 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://fabiansanglard.net/tb4/index.html>

(No summary)

14. Don't you mean extinct?

Source: Fabien Sanglard | Published: 10 Jul 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://fabiansanglard.net/extinct/index.html>

(No summary)

15. Pluralistic: Workplace "flexibility" isn't (11 Jul 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Sat, 11 Jul 2026 08:54:28 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/07/11/your-risk/>

Today's links Workplace "flexibility" isn't: What the gig economy calls flexibility is just risk-shifting. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: "Alanya to Alanya"; ToS are the internet's biggest lie; Soviet jokes; Fox rapists v gag orders; GBAO is the future; "Fun Family"; Sacklers get to keep the loot. Upcoming appearances: London, Edinburgh, Sydney, Melbourne, Brighton, London, South Bend. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Workplace "flexibility" isn't (permalink) Here's an irony: the "gig economy" is a statistical black hole. Workers, customers and regulators know very little about the most basic aspects of it: how much workers get paid, for example, or much unpaid time on the clock a worker puts in before they get a job from the app. The reason this is ironic is that the "gig economy" is dominated by a handful of massive, data-driven firms that know the precise, up-to-the-second answer to these questions. The problem is that they won't share the data. Of course, workers and customers have the data, too, but our data is...

16. Goede geluiden over digitale autonomie

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sat, 11 Jul 2026 12:00:13 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/goede-geluiden-over-digitale-autonomie/>

De Tweede Kamer is met reces, en de out of office replies vanuit de overheid beginnen indrukwekkende vormen aan te nemen. Kunnen ze in Amerika nog wat van leren. Maar, er worden nog steeds dingen gepubliceerd, en het is opvallend hoeveel goeds er recent gezegd is over digitale autonomie. De tl;dr is dat er een duidelijke wending zichtbaar is. Na een decennium van ontkenning publiceren allerhande stukken overheid nu ronkende teksten over digitale autonomie en staan die teksten ook vol goede voornemens en besluiten.